

North Carolina Mental Health & Substance Use Services Workforce Data 2024 Snapshot:

LICENSED PSYCHOLOGICAL ASSOCIATES



709

**Total Licensed
Psychological Associates**
Active Practice

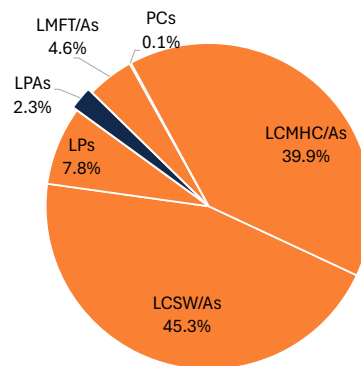
431

Clinical LPAs
Licensed Psychological
Associates, Clinical Specialty

278

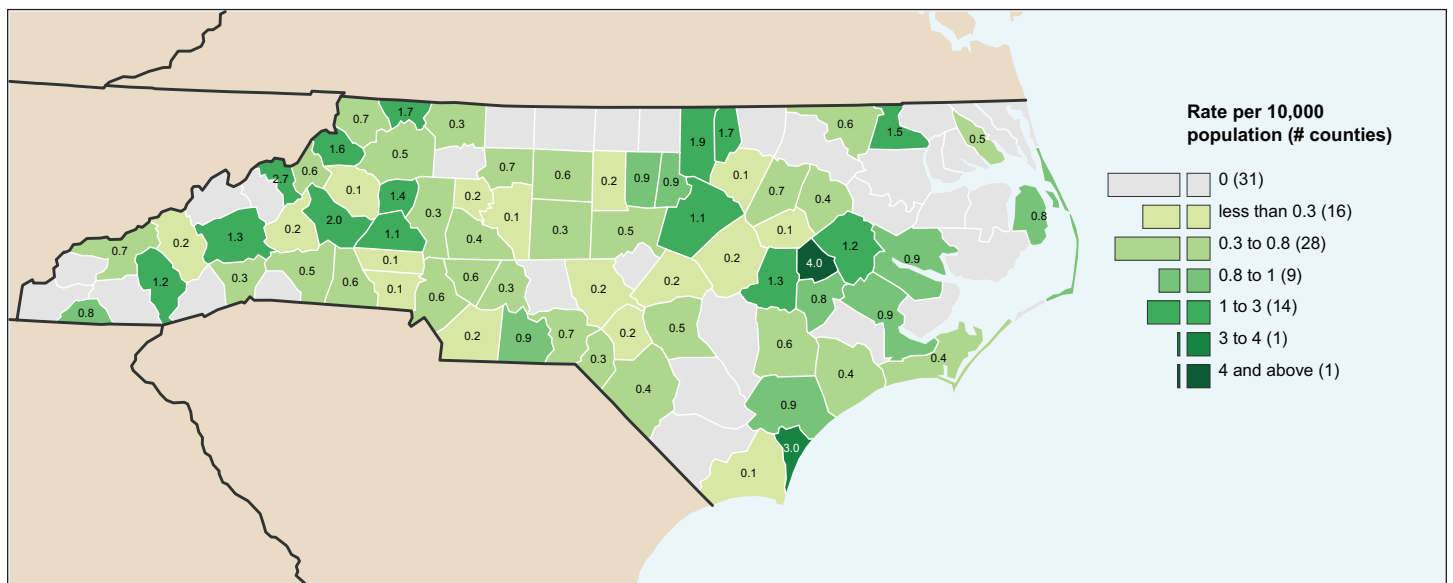
Other LPAs
Licensed Psychological
Associates, Other Specialties

- The average rate for LPAs in-state was **0.65 per 10,000** population.
- The rate of LPAs per 10,000 decreased since 2014 (0.84).
- LPAs comprised **2.3%** of the entire graduate-level workforce across North Carolina.
- LPAs were composed of specialties: **Clinical (60.8%)**, School (19.5%), Counseling (6.6%), and Other/None (13.1%).

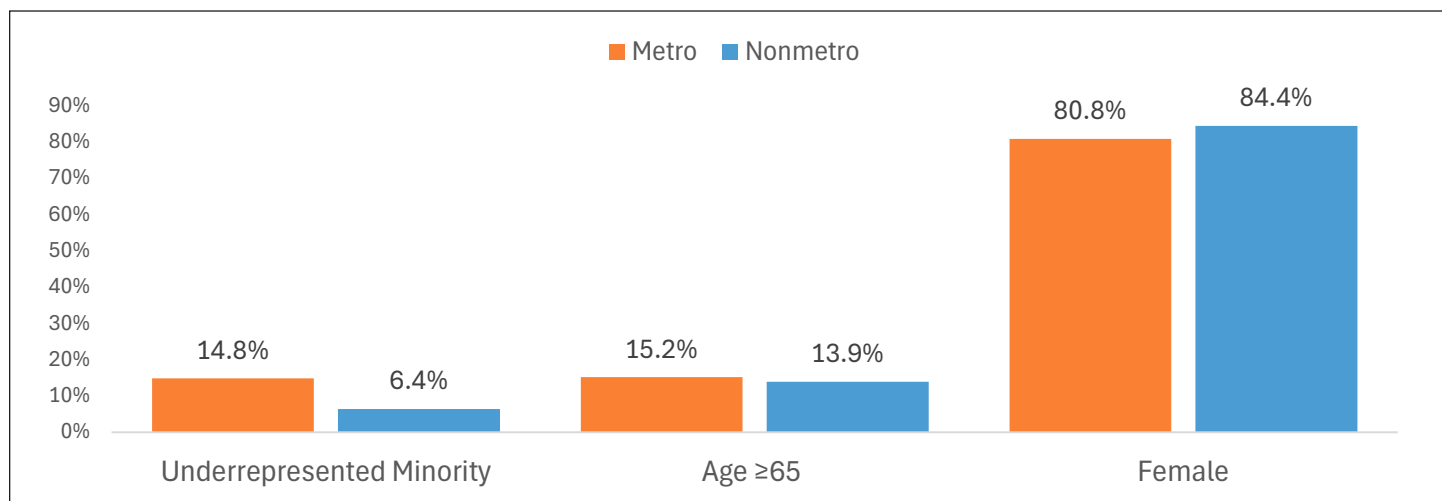


- LP = Licensed Psychologist
- LMFT = Licensed Marriage and Family Therapist
- LMFTA = Licensed Marriage and Family Therapists Associate
- PC = Pastoral Counselor
- LCMHC = Licensed Clinical Mental Health Counselor
- LCMHCA = Licensed Clinical Mental Health Counselor Associate
- LCSW = Licensed Clinical Social Worker
- LCSWA = Licensed Clinical Social Worker Associate

Licensed Psychological Associates per 10,000 Population by County, North Carolina, 2024



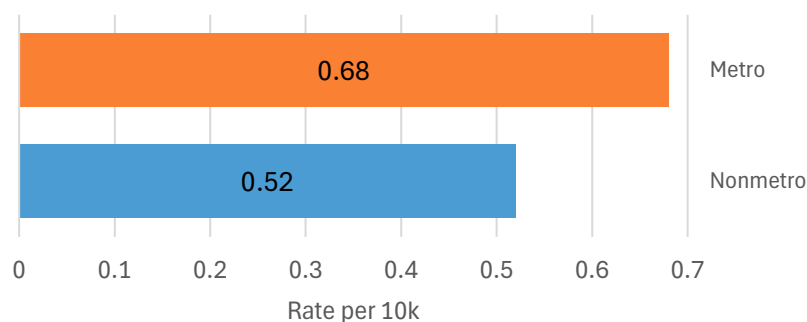
Licensed Psychological Associates Workforce Demographics by Urbanicity, 2024



Education

- **51.3% of LPAs** were educated in-state in 2024 compared to 58.0% in 2014
- 90.5% of LPAs held a Master's degree
- 9.5% of LPAs held a Doctorate

LPAs in Metro and Nonmetro Counties, 2024



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The state average was **0.65 LPAs per 10,000 population**, with uneven distribution throughout the state
- Almost a third of counties (**31**) had **0 LPAs** per 10,000 population. 81 counties had a rate per 10k below the state average.
- **Metro and nonmetro counties had somewhat similar rates** (0.68 metro vs 0.52 nonmetro).
- The workforce size declined 15% from 2014 to 2024 and **lowered in rate per 10k from 0.84 to 0.65**.
- Differences between LPAs in metro and nonmetro counties are seen in the proportion of underrepresented minorities. Overall, LPAs were 81.4% female, 17.2% ≥65, and 13.3% identified as underrepresented minorities.

For more information, please find the full report at: <https://nhealthworkforce.unc.edu/projects/mhsu-workforce/>



NC DEPARTMENT OF
**HEALTH AND
HUMAN SERVICES**
Division of Mental Health,
Developmental Disabilities and
Substance Use Services

**SHEPS HEALTH
WORKFORCE NC**

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